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Graduate Recruitment Team

Rothschild & Co

New Court, St Swithin's Lane

London EC4N 8AL

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Evergreen – 2027 Global Advisory Graduate Programme in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Rothschild & Co's role as joint lead financial adviser to McCormick on its combination with Unilever's Foods business, announced in March 2026, sits right where my interest in food and agribusiness transactions began.

My clearest preparation for banking has been taking transactions apart. As co-founder and Treasurer of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, the university's first agri-finance society, I grew membership to 126 and led weekly research sessions on deals such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, explaining the strategic rationale, the deal structure and the valuation to members, including many from outside finance. My strongest academic results are in the same territory: 90% in first-year Finance and 78%, the second-highest mark, in a third-year group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets.

Investment banking appeals to me because every transaction is a chain of judgements about who should buy, why now and at what price, and each one has to survive scrutiny from clients and counterparties. The analyst's part in that chain is accuracy under deadline, a habit I have built outside the classroom. For nearly two years at KONG, I reconciled end-of-shift cash and card takings while studying full-time. I now run the drinks programme as Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover Glasgow venue, where I wrote the batch specifications and trained around 15 bar staff to standards that have to hold when someone else executes them.

Rothschild & Co's Global Advisory business stands out to me because its independence lets it lead complex cross-border transactions such as McCormick's \$66 billion combination with Unilever Foods, structured as a Reverse Morris Trust and described by the firm as the second-largest food transaction ever. Explaining why SALIC wanted a stake in Olam Agri taught me that the structure of a deal often matters as much as its headline value, and I would like to learn that craft from the bankers who design deals like this one.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan